



February

QUEST Newsletter



Fall in love with one of our featured opportunities for this month!

International Academic Competitions

UNITED STATES DIVISION

The QUEST Department is proud to host and cover the registration fees for all round 1 participants of these international academic competitions!



National Science Bee

February 24, 2026
During QRT in the Library Classroom



NATIONAL POLITICAL SCIENCE BEE

February 26, 2026
During QRT in the Library Classroom



National Biology Bee

February 27, 2026
During QRT in the Library Classroom



United States History Bee

March 3, 2026
During QRT in the Library Classroom



National Geography Bee

March 5, 2026
During QRT in the Library Classroom



National Humanities Bee

March 6, 2026
During QRT in the Library Classroom

Further competition advancement registration and fees will be the responsibility of the student.

All interested students should contact Lesley_Cowles@fcasd.edu.

Registration forms are available in the QUEST office

IMPORTANT DATES:

2/1: Register for summer FCAO courses before scheduling begins!

2/1: CMU Math & Science Academy application deadline

2/3: Food Bank Field Trip

2/5: High School Open House

2/9: Magee-Womens Internship application deadline

2/6: 1pm early dismissal (high school students only)

2/11: Math Madness – QRT

2/13: Student Police Academy application deadline

2/15: UPMC Hillman Academy application deadline

2/12: F=MA Physics Exam

2/16: No school – Presidents' Day

2/17: American Scholastic Mathematics Assoc. Contest

2/18: Math Madness – QRT

2/20: Career speakers during QRT

2/24: Natl. Science Bee – QRT

2/26: 2/24: Natl. Political Science Bee – QRT

2/27: Natl. Biology Bee – QRT

2/25: World Affairs Institute

2/25: Math Madness – QRT

2/: AP test registration forms due

3/1: SAT Boot Camp

FC Hacks Hackathon 2026

A 100% online hackathon for Pittsburgh students

The FC Hacks club invites middle and high school students to participate in their online hackathon on Saturday, March 7th from 9 AM to 6 PM. Participating students will program for eight hours to address one of the world's pressing issues. This year, we plan to welcome students from a variety of schools to create solutions to help humanity. Competitors will be provided assistance from qualified teachers who can help participants through masterclasses and Q&A sessions. Any level of programming experience is welcome, as everyone who participates can either compete for awards and certificates of completion, teach, or even judge final projects. This will be a great opportunity to meet new people who are experienced in tech! If you are interested in participating as a competitor, teacher or judge, please visit our website to complete the interest form at <https://fc-hacks.onrender.com/>. Questions should be addressed to prakash_kaniskgaurav@student.fcasd.edu



PSBR'S SPARC 2026 STUDENT CONTESTS
Biomedical Research Saves Lives

The Pennsylvania Society of Biomedical Research essay, poster, and digital media contests offer *cash prizes* and more for students of all ages. All contests are free to enter, and students may submit an entry for all three contests. Along with cash prizes, all winners and their family will receive an invitation to their Annual Awards Dinner on June 19, 2026! Because this is a local contest, the chances of winning are greatly increased! Almost every year a student from FCAHS wins one of the offered prizes in this contest. You are strongly encouraged to participate!

The submission deadline is March 8, 2026.

psbr.org



Pennsylvania Society for Biomedical Research



National History Day Pittsburgh 2026

“Revolution, Reaction, Reform in History.”



Location: Heinz History Center
Dates: March 21 and March 22, 2026

National History Day draws upon a unique historical theme each year and encourages middle school and high school students to research history in an exciting and creative way.

Enter one of five categories

Paper, performance,
documentary, exhibit, or
website.

Submissions

Individually
Teams of 2-5 for all categories (except
paper, in which students must
compete individually).

Register & Pay Online:

<https://pa-nhdp.nhd.org/App?f=e4d547b1-6088-49d2-aa75-3a30eb0979b6>

FCAHS Contact: Dr. Cowles
Lesley.Cowles@fcasd.edu

Important NHD Competition Dates

- Registration Opens –January 12, 2026
- Registration Deadline –February 25, 2026
- Online Submission Deadline –March 4, 2026

Attend Independently:

- Junior Division Competition –March 21, 2026
- Senior Division Competition –March 22, 2026

Regional Fees: \$11.00 - Paid by individual participants

- Due by February 25, 2026
- Student can have two additional guests with them the day of the competition at no additional cost.

EVER WONDER WHAT IT'S LIKE BEHIND THE BADGE?

Join Pittsburgh's **Citizen Police Academy** to Find Out!

REGISTER BY:

FEBRUARY 13, 2026

STARTS

FEBRUARY 25, 2026

WEEKLY SESSIONS

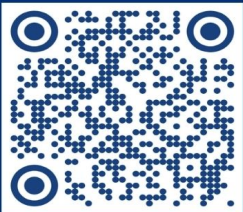
WEDNESDAY'S

6:30 PM - 8:30 PM

JEWISH COMMUNITY CENTER
5738 DARLINGTON RD.
PITTSBURGH, PA 15217



**LIMITED SEATS!
APPLY TODAY!**



SCAN QR CODE TO APPLY OR VISIT
[PITTSBURGHPA.GOV/SAFETY/PUBLIC-
SAFETY/VIOLENCE-PREVENTION/
STUDENT-AND-CITIZENS-POLICE-
ACADEMY](https://pittsburghpa.gov/safety/public-safety/violence-prevention/student-and-citizens-police-academy)

*PARTICIPANTS MUST BE 19 YEARS OLD

The Pittsburgh Bureau of Police offers residents a chance to engage in police training through the Citizens' Police Academy (CPA), a free program that provides a safe environment to learn about police operations. Over 12 weeks, participants receive two hours of training weekly on topics including:

- Criminal law
- Patrol tactics
- Police accountability
- Specialized units
- Police canines
- Crime scene processing
- and much more!



Questions

Contact John Tokarski
john.tokarski@pittsburghpa.gov
412-432-8674

**SUBMIT TO
TAPESTRY**

submit creative
writing or art
pieces

meetings are
the 2nd and 4th
Thursday of
every month

submission
deadline:
february 14

questions?
come to room
176

submit here!

@fctapestry
foxchapeltapestry@gmail.com



Junior Only School Day SAT

will be on Thursday, April
23, 2025 at FCAHS. If you're interested in signing
up to take the SAT, please bring your completed
form and check made payable to FCAHS to the
school counseling office before March 20. See your
school counselor for more information.



Teens learn the vital art of diplomacy

I WANT TO BE AN AMBASSADOR

Master the skills and character traits of successful Ambassadors

As the world stage continues to evolve one facet remains critically important, the vital art of **diplomacy**. *I Want to be an Ambassador!* camp is designed to prepare our teenagers with the skills necessary to come together and work to solve problems, whether they are close to home or in the world at large by teaching, demonstrating and practicing the skills of an Ambassador!

This seven-day summer camp experience is the only program of its kind in Western Pennsylvania, making it a unique and significant offering. The *I Want to be an Ambassador!* camp offers an original, innovative, and progressive curriculum that teaches useful lessons and critical thinking skills that teens can apply in their daily lives.

PROGRAM DETAILS

Dates: June 9-17, 2026

(June 9-12 in Pittsburgh)

(June 15-17 in Washington DC)

Time: 9:00 am – 3:30 pm (excluding weekends)

Target Audience: Rising 8th – 12th graders

Location: Winchester Thurston Upper School, 555 Morewood Ave, Pittsburgh, PA 15213 and various embassies and historical sites in Washington DC

Tuition: \$895.00 (\$870.00, if application is submitted or postmarked before May 1) Tuition is not refundable.

For more information, visit:

<https://www.luminari.org/teens-learn-the-vital-art-of-diplomacy/>

HEALTH & BIOMEDICAL SCIENCES CAMP

Lebanon Valley College



Camp Details

When: The Health and Biomedical Sciences Summer Camp will be held from July 27–August 1, 2026.

Where: Lebanon Valley College, Annville, PA

Cost: \$1,275

Who: Rising high school sophomores, juniors, and seniors

<https://www.lvc.edu/about/camps-community-programming/health-biomedical-sciences-camp/>

Through lectures and hands-on laboratory investigations in state-of-the-art laboratories, students will be introduced to the fundamentals of disciplines such as molecular biology, neuroscience, physiology, pharmacology, immunology, and other medical sciences. Students will learn how laboratory science can be translated into improved human health and will engage in investigative experiences that will allow them to apply their laboratory skills to real-life problems. In addition, students will interact with practicing professionals in fields such as medicine, physical therapy, toxicology, genetic counseling, and biomedical laboratory research. The Health and Biomedical Sciences Summer Camp will provide a fun, challenging, and engaging college environment in which students will develop a deeper understanding of what it means to be a biomedical scientist and health professional.



Air Force Association CyberCamp

June 22-26, 2026 – FREE!

Each year, Pitt Cyber, in partnership with Pitt Digital, hosts the Air Force Association CyberCamp. This week-long camp is free and open to high school students and teaches cybersecurity principles, skills, and future career opportunities. The CyberCamp and its commitment to building a strong pipeline of cybersecurity professionals was highlighted recently by the White House!

The camp is designed for a range of technical skill levels, including introductory digital literacy, and is focused on systems security and cyber ethics. Taught by cybersecurity professionals from the University of Pittsburgh and elsewhere, students learn in-demand skills like cyber hygiene, Windows and Ubuntu system administration, and more. The camp concludes with students competing to find and fix vulnerabilities in a virtual machine environment.

<https://www.cyber.pitt.edu/cybercamp>



GOVERNOR'S SCHOOL
FOR GLOBAL & INTERNATIONAL STUDIES

University of Pittsburgh Campus

**June 27th
to
July 26th**

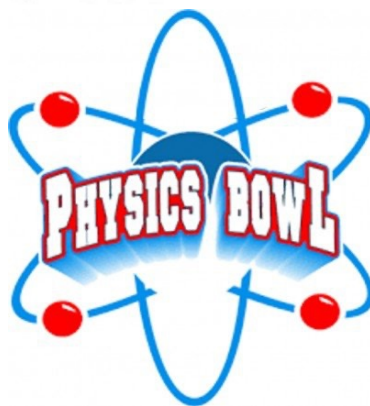
The Governor's School for Global and International Studies prepares high-school sophomores and juniors to understand global and transnational processes through a four-week residential program hosted at the University of Pittsburgh's main campus. The program's unique curriculum and residential environment encourage students to engage with the world in a fun, intense, and immersive way. Learn more about the 2026 Governors School and apply at <http://www.govschool.pitt.edu/>

The American Association of Physics Teachers presents:

PHYSICSBOWL

Competition Details:

- All students are welcome to compete.
- March 21, 2025, during career QRT
 - Arrive at 7:25 to begin competition at 7:30.
- 45-minutes to complete
- 2 Divisions:
- Division 1: first-year physics students
- Division 2: second-year physics students
- 40 multiple-choice questions
- Basic calculators can be used. Calculator can't have programs.
- FCASD covers the cost to enter



Past Practice Exams: <https://aapt.org/Programs/PhysicsBowl/printexams.cfm>

Competition Location: Multipurpose Room (Fox Media Hallway)

Competition Results: Posted in early May

To Register:

- Send Dr. Cowles an email to register -- Lesley.Cowles@fcasd.edu
- Indicate whether you qualify for Division 1 or Division 2.
- Registration deadline: **March 18, 2025**

Johns Hopkins University Summer Courses



Johns Hopkins is offering four summer courses for high school students:

- Explore Engineering Innovation (in-person or online)
- Biomedical Engineering Innovation (online)
- Sustainable Energy Innovation (in-person or online)
- Intro to Python (online)

Visit <https://ei.jhu.edu/> for details, application and pricing.

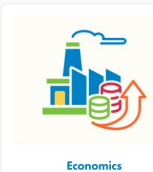
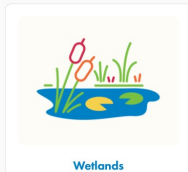
The World of 8 Billion Challenge

Create a one-minute video that addresses one of this year's global topics, suggests a sustainable solution, and connects how human population growth impacts that topic.

Submission deadline: March 4, 2026

This Year's Contest Topics

Human population issues remain central to the contest, but the specific global challenges we address change each year.



Through the *World of 8 Billion* student video contest, middle and high schoolers are given the platform to think critically about global challenges related to population and share what they think should be done to fix it. Entries are being accepted now through March 4, 2026.

<https://www.worldof8billion.org/video-contest/>

First place winner: \$1,200

Second Place Winner: \$600

Two Honorable Mention Winners: \$300

Job Shadowing Opportunities at UPMC Mercy!

UPMC Mercy invites teens ages 14-18 to apply to shadow a professional in one of the following areas: Respiratory Care, Nursing, Radiology.

If you are interested in any of these areas, please email Ms. Donna Shivers (*Manager, Volunteer & Community Services*) at shiversd@upmc.edu and she can give you the information to apply to shadow. Your visit would be Monday through Friday anytime between 8am-4pm. Most shadows are 8am-12pm. Please contact her with any questions.

UPMC | SPORTS
MEDICINE

UPMC Sports Medicine Virtual Sports Medicine Career Day Wednesday, March 4, 2026 — 8:15am-11am

Geared toward students interested in a career in sports medicine, the program will be approximately 2.5 hours long and will feature a variety of career opportunities supporting athletes of all types. Each speaker will give a 15-minute introduction to their career which will include information such as educational background, job opportunities, salary, future of the profession, what interested them in their career choice, and an example of a typical day. The program may vary, but anticipated presenters include an athletic trainer with both professional sports and one in the performing arts, physician assistant, sports nutritionist, physical therapist, a program director/clinical coordinator for an athletic training program and more. The finalized program will be sent to those expressing interest in attending, and students will have an opportunity to email their questions to the speakers ahead of time.

Anyone wishing to virtually attend the program should email Lisa_Gibson@fcasd.edu for further directions.

HARVARD POLITICAL REVIEW

ESSAY

COMPETITION 2026

For Middle & High School Students



Registration Deadline

Priority	Jan 15, 2026
Regular	Feb 15, 2026
Late	Mar 15, 2026

Competition Period

Submission Deadline

Mar 20, 2026



Visit algoed.co/hpr for more information.

American Association of Human Genetics



<https://www.ashg.org/dna-day/>

This contest is open to students in grades 9-12 worldwide and asks students to examine, question, and reflect on important concepts in genetics. Choose one genetic treatment or therapy that has been developed or widely used in recent years. Explain what the treatment is and how it works. Discuss its advantages and disadvantages. Think about ethical issues, effects on society, cost, and accessibility. If you or someone you care about had this condition, would you choose this treatment? Please explain why, considering things like age, overall health, cost factors, etc

Important Dates

- March 4, 2026: Submission site closes
- April 24, 2026: DNA Day! Winners announced

Prizes:

1st Place : \$1,000 for student, \$1,000 genetics materials grant

2nd Place : \$600 for student, \$600 genetics materials grant

3rd Place : \$400 for student, \$400 genetics materials grant

Honorable Mentions: 10 student prizes of \$100 each

Questions? Email dnaday@ashg.org



Point Park University's Accelerated Career Awareness Program

Registration is NOW OPEN!

- Sunday, July 26 - Friday, July 31, 2026 |
- On-Ground – Residential
- For sophomores, juniors and seniors
- FREE!

The field of accounting has been identified as one of the fastest-growing professions, according to the U.S. Bureau of Labor. Yet studies have shown that there has been declining enrollment in accounting and finance among underrepresented students. The goal of the Accelerated Career Awareness Program, is to increase the understanding of accounting career opportunities among high school students in underrepresented minority groups.

Apply today at

<https://www.pointpark.edu/academics/schools/business/urbanaccountinginitiative/acap/index>



The Japan-America Society of Pennsylvania

ペンシルベニア日米協会

High School Japanese Speech Contest

Friday, March 6th – 9am-2pm

Carnegie Museum of Art

This competition is designed for high school studying Japanese language. Japanese language students of all levels and students who are involved in Japan-related cultural activities, are able to compete against other area students in speech or poster activities. Non-language students are eligible to compete in the poster contest. Each year over 80 students participate. There will be lots of fun Japan-related activities for participating students and parents. Students who compete in speech levels are required to write and memorize a speech on the chosen topic for the contest. Winners receive prizes and trophies! **2026 Themes:**

Beginner Level: Self-Introduction

All Other Levels: 祭り (Festivals)

The contest is held in partnership with the University of Pittsburgh and Carnegie Museum of Art.

If you are interested in participating, please contact the Educational Outreach Coordinator, kshellhammer@japansocietypa.org for more information.

<https://www.japansocietypa.org/Speech-Contest>



America's 250th: Research Our Founding Values



Essay and Video Contests Return for 2025-26—Plus a New AI Challenge!

Our contests invite students to tackle big ideas, sharpen skills, and express themselves in thoughtful, creative ways. Middle school, high school, and college students compete in divisions (which vary by contest) for recognition and cash prizes. Students can enter on their own, or teachers can assign the contests and earn rewards for their students' participation.

Whether you're ready to write, record, or explore with AI—or support your students as they do—these contests are a great way to build critical thinking and strengthen communication!

<https://stosselintheclassroom.org/student-contests/>

Contest Deadline: March 13, 2026



Essay Contest

Showcase your ideas and writing skills by crafting a compelling essay.

Divisions: Middle School & High School



Video Contest

Tell your story through the lens of creativity and persuasion in a short video.

Divisions: Middle School, High School & College



AI Challenge—New This Year!

Use AI to explore both sides of an issue—then reflect on what you learned

Divisions: High School



Cash Prizes

Over \$28,000 available across all contests.



Recognition

Get noticed for work that makes people think.



Prepare for the Future

Develop essential skills that last a lifetime.

PITT | SWANSON
ENGINEERING
BIOENGINEERING
CAMPBIOE 2.0

CampBioE 2.0 is a dynamic day camp that engages scholars (2nd to 12th grade) in science, technology, engineering, mathematics, and medicine (STEM+) through exposure to hands on bioengineering and STEM+ activities!

The first weeks from June 22 - 26, 2026 and July 6 -10, 2026 are High School 3D Bioprinting. Each week is \$500 but can be waived if the household qualifies for the National School Breakfast and Lunch Program for Pennsylvania.

Register today at:

<https://www.engineering.pitt.edu/departments/bioengineering/campbioe/>

RxPlore

Summer 2026
University of
Pittsburgh School
of Pharmacy



July 24 – 26 2025 from 9am-4pm at the University of Pittsburgh School of Pharmacy
Created for rising high school juniors and seniors, RxPLORE is a professional summer camp that provides exposure to the critical role pharmacists play within healthcare. If you already have a passion for pharmacy or are just starting to explore career options within the healthcare field, RxPLORE is right for you! Form valuable connections with faculty and current pharmacy students while you explore some of the many career options available for a PharmD!

More information and registration -

<https://www.rxplore.pharmacy.pitt.edu/>



WAVE Hands-On Saturdays

Feb 21, 2026 10:00 AM - 12:00 PM

This in-person workshop is designed for students in grades 6–12 interested in science, technology, engineering, and math (STEM) topics and careers in the skilled trades.

Participants will engage in:

- A fun icebreaker
- Career path discussions
- Interactive STEAM challenges

All necessary materials will be provided at no cost to participants. Future sessions will be held on April 11, October 10 and December 12.

Register today by visiting

<https://www.alcosan.org/educational-activities/scholastic-upcoming-events>



2026/2027

**National Honor Society
Letters of Eligibility
(Sophomores & Juniors)**

Current sophomores and juniors who have a non-weighted CUMULATIVE QPA of 3.70 or higher will get a letter in the mail inviting them to apply to National Honor Society (NHS) for the 2026/2027 school year. Letters will be mailed home on February 16th. A detailed explanation of the requirements for acceptance to NHS is available in the FCAHS Student/Parent Handbook under the "Activities" section. This file is available electronically at fcasd.edu/other/fcahs-handbook

Important dates:

- February 16th: Letters of Eligibility mailed home
- March 16th: QRT meeting to get your application
- April 24th: Application Due Date
- September 10th: Induction Ceremony



Go Abroad with AFS-USA!

Conroy Guyer Memorial Scholarship (only for FCAHS sophomores:

applications are now available!

This scholarship application for an all expense paid, 2-week summer program to Ghana, Kenya or Spain has been made possible through the generosity of Mr. Conroy Guyer, a former English teacher at Fox Chapel Area High School. Three **SOPHOMORE** students will be awarded these scholarships (one for each country) as part of the Global Prep program through AFS. You will travel with a chaperoned group of 20-30 students. All transportation, lodging and meal expenses will be paid by the scholarship. Sophomores enrolled at FCAHS who could gain significant benefit from the experience, but who otherwise would not be able to go due to financial need, are eligible to apply. Applications are included on the last 2 pages of this QUEST newsletter and are due Feb. 14, 2026.



AFS-USA empowers people to become globally engaged citizens by delivering meaningful intercultural experiences that create a more peaceful world. Our short-term summer programs provide an opportunity for high school students to discover a new culture, make lifelong friendships, and gain invaluable skills and knowledge through immersive learning.

Summer 2026 Programs

2-8 Week Programs

Accelerated programs that include language learning, homestays, and attending a local high school.

Destinations: **Argentina, China, Costa Rica, France, Japan, Malaysia, Scandinavia, and Spain**

1-3 Week Global Prep Programs

Intensive programs covering themes such as language learning, sustainable development, and environmental conservation.

Destinations: **Colombia, Egypt, Kenya, and Spain**

Scholarships

At AFS-USA, we believe finances shouldn't stand in the way of studying abroad. Thanks to our generous donors, AFS Global Citizen Scholarships & Aid (GCSA) provides funding for students with financial need.

The scholarship deadline for 2026 summer programs is March 5th, 2026.

To be considered for AFS-USA financial aid for a summer program, students must complete both the initial stage of the study abroad application and the scholarship application by this date.

For more information or to get in touch with our Study Abroad Specialists:
1.800.AFS.INFO or studyabroad@afsususa.org

afsususa.org/study-abroad



**PRACTICE
MATERIALS
PROVIDED!**

WESTERN PENNSYLVANIA
LEARNING ACADEMY
presents

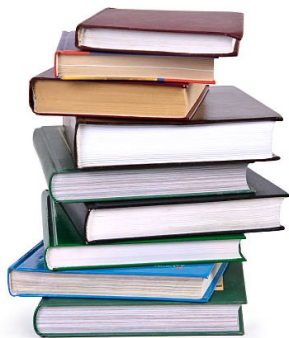
SAT[®]

**BOOT
CAMP**

Sunday, March 1, 2026

Noon – 5 p.m.

Fox Chapel Area High School LGI



- Test taking and time management tips
- Intensive grammar & usage skills review
- Intensive math skills review
- Critical reading skills and strategies
- Practice drills with actual test questions
- Experienced and highly-trained instructors

\$100
Cash or check
payable to FCASD

This program is most suitable for students who have successfully completed Algebra 2.

Please bring with you a graphing calculator and laptop.

Contact Lisa_Gibson@fcasd.edu if you do not have access to these items.

****PRE-REGISTRATION IS REQUIRED****

Student Name: _____ Grade: _____

Student Email: _____ School District: _____

Mailing Address: _____

Parent/Guardian Name: _____ Phone: _____

Parent/Guardian Email: _____

Please make checks payable to Fox Chapel Area School District (FCASD).

No refunds issued after February 25, 2026

*Submit check and completed registration form (front and back)
either in person (Fox Chapel Area High School room 168) or via mail to:*

Lisa Gibson, Director
Western PA Learning Academy
Fox Chapel Area High School
611 Field Club Road
Pittsburgh, PA 15238

The well-being of any child is a parental responsibility. In an emergency, every effort will be made to contact a parent/guardian. Please list two persons who can arrange transportation and care for your child when you are not available.

Relative or Friend: _____ Phone: _____

Relative or Friend: _____ Phone: _____

WESTERN PENNSYLVANIA LEARNING ACADEMY

Program Permission Form



Student Name: _____

I, _____ give permission for my child to attend the assigned date of the Western Pennsylvania Learning Academy's SAT Boot Camp. In the event of an emergency, if treatment is required and parents/guardians cannot be notified immediately, I give consent for emergency treatment and transport to the nearest emergency room.

Does your child have any health concerns that would hinder participation in the field experience? _____ No _____ Yes. If yes, please complete the following:

Please indicate if your child has any of the following health concerns:

_____ Asthma	_____ Inhaler needed
_____ Life-threatening allergy to bee sting	_____ EpiPen
_____ Life-threatening allergy to food	_____ Benadryl needed
_____ Seizure disorder	_____ Diabetes
_____ Allergy to _____	Other _____

Emergency Treatment (if needed): _____

Health Insurance: _____

Family Physician: _____ Phone: _____

My signature confirms that my child has permission to participate in all activities on the specified dates. Permission is also granted to share this information with appropriate academy personnel.

Parent Signature: _____ Date: _____

Cell Phone #: _____ Work Phone #: _____

Cancellation policy:

We understand situations arise when you may need to cancel your reservation. To do so, we request you notify us at least 24 hours in advance. This allows us to offer your slot to another student on the waiting list. Cancellations or rescheduling requests made less than 24 hours before the event may be subject to a cancellation fee of 30%. No-shows without prior notification will not be refunded. In case of emergencies or unforeseen circumstances, please contact us directly to discuss your situation. We may be able to waive the cancellation fee at our discretion.

Fox Chapel Area Online Summer 2026 Course Offerings

Open to students currently enrolled in grades 9, 10, and 11.

Online courses run for 5 weeks from

Friday, June 12 through Friday, July 17

Application deadline: February 28, 2026

FCAO Career and Financial Essentials



For students entering grades 11 or 12, **Career and Financial Essentials** complements all disciplines and other standards by developing postsecondary goals regarding career planning and financial literacy. Students will embark on a career search, compose a job application, and develop a personal résumé. Students will also learn about consumer skills, debit/credit, budgeting, and taxes. The culminating experience is a one-on-one professional interview that will be conducted in the fall. All activities are completed online. Assignments are due weekly, but students may work ahead, if desired.
.5 credits

FCAO SAT Prep



For students entering grades 11 or 12, **SAT Prep** helps students strengthen their skills using Khan Academy's SAT Practice modules to build test readiness. Students will complete two full-length, timed SAT practice tests to simulate real testing conditions and track their progress. Lessons focus on improving performance in Reading, Writing, and Math. Additionally, students learn test-taking strategies, including familiarity with the Bluebook testing app utilized by College Board. Weekly assignments help students stay accountable and steadily improve their scores.
.5 credits

FCAO Discovery Health



For students entering 10th grade, **Discovery Health** allows students to apply wellness concepts to the study of the human body. Utilizing basic facts about the body systems, students will discover how daily decisions can impact the operation of the human body. This is a required course for graduation from FCAHS. It meets the PA State Standards for Health, Safety, and Physical Education. All activities are completed online. Assignments are due weekly, but students may work ahead, if desired.
.5 credits

**** These are compressed courses. Students are completing an entire course in five weeks. ****

Frequently Asked Questions:

What is the format of these classes? These classes are fully online & asynchronous, with weekly due dates.

What if a student is on vacation for part of the 5 weeks? Students can choose to work while on vacation or complete their assignments ahead of time. The late work policy will apply to all students, regardless of travel plans, so it is important to plan accordingly.

What is the late work policy? Late work is accepted up to one week with a 20% penalty; no work is accepted beyond one week late. No work is accepted beyond the last day of class, Friday, July 17th. The expectation is that all students will follow the course schedule due to the compressed nature of the classes.

How much should be expected for these classes? These classes are the same semester-long classes compressed into five weeks.

Can a student take more than one course? It is possible, but the student should consider their schedule and availability to complete multiple semester courses in a five-week span.

How do I register? Spaces are limited and classes get full. Spots are filled on a first-come, first-serve basis. A student isn't enrolled until the form AND check are received. No refunds are available after June 1st.

Fox Chapel Area Online
Summer High School Course Registration
Courses run from June 12 – July 17
Open to students currently enrolled in grades 9, 10, and 11
Registration Deadline: February 28, 2026

I would like to register for the following summer course(s):

- ☐ FCAO College and Career Essentials (grades 11 & 12), \$200.00
 - ☐ FCAO SAT Prep (grades 11 & 12), \$200.00
 - ☐ FCAO Health (grade 10), \$200.00
-

Student Name: _____

Current Grade Level (circle): 9 10 11

Student Email: _____@student.fcasd.edu

Student Phone : _____

Parent/Guardian Name: _____

Parent/Guardian Phone: _____

Parent/Guardian Email: _____

SPACE IS VERY LIMITED!
STUDENTS ARE NOT ENROLLED
UNTIL REGISTRATION AND PAYMENT ARE SUBMITTED.
NO REFUNDS after June 1, 2026.

Please make check payable (separate check per course) to:
Fox Chapel Area School District (FCASD)

Submit check and form either in-person (high school room 168) or via mail to:

Lisa Gibson
FCAHS Summer School Registration
611 Field Club Road
Pittsburgh, PA 15238

Contact Lisa_Gibson@fcasd.edu (412-967-2479) with any questions.

The Conroy Guyer Memorial Scholarship Application 2026

2026 Summer Program – AFS USA Ghana July 10-28 Kenya July 17-31 Spain July 10-24

This scholarship application is for 2-week summer programs to Ghana, Kenya and Spain, which have been made possible through the generosity of Mr. Conroy Guyer. As a former teacher at FCAHS, Mr. Guyer wanted to expand students' horizons and help them achieve their highest potential. Three students will be awarded these scholarships (one for each country) as part of the Global Prep program through AFS USA, an internationally recognized program for exchange students. You will travel with a chaperoned group of 20-30 students. All transportation, lodging, and meal expenses will be paid by the scholarship.

Ghana: Ghana is well known for its vibrant atmosphere and friendly people. During this 18 day program, you will learn about Ghanaian traditions and modern society, while living with a host family in the capital city of Accra. In addition, you will go on excursions to other large cities like Cape Coast and Kumasi. Ghana's official language is English, so you will be able to jump right in from day one and while living with a local family you will quickly immerse yourself in the local culture. Other activities include visiting castles, a monkey sanctuary, waterfalls, and a cocoa processing plant

Kenya: Spend two weeks exploring the nature and beauty of Kenya with this program which was created by Kenyans to give you an authentic, impactful experience. You will live with a vetted local family and explore national parks and wildlife reservations. You will also visit their capital, Nairobi, and you will see habitats for lions and rhinos. Later in your visit, you will also stay on a nature reserve with a family from the Maasai tribe, a semi-nomadic tribe and they will introduce you to their culture and way of life. You will be able to go on a safari and throughout your visit, you will learn how the Kenyans preserve and protect the natural beauty of their country.

Spain: This two-week adventure takes you to the historic town of Valladolid, Spain, north of Madrid, where you will have the opportunity to study Spanish in the morning and then learn about Spanish culture and explore historic sites such as palaces, castles and Roman ruins. The city is known for the "best spoken Spanish in Spain," and locals are happy to help you learn and practice your Spanish. You will live with a vetted host family, and you will have a chance to tutor local teenagers in English as well as understand issues that impact them today.

Please circle one or more of the countries you would like to be considered for and rank them by writing a number next to the country. Ghana _____ Kenya _____ Spain _____

The Conroy Guyer Memorial SCHOLARSHIP APPLICATION

Sophomores enrolled at FCAHS who could gain significant benefit from this experience, but who otherwise would not be able to go due to financial need, are eligible to apply. Students are encouraged to return to FCAHS the following school year and share information about the program and the benefits gained with other students. They will be encouraged to meet other AFS Exchange Students and participate in other local AFS activities. Please write on the back if you need more room for your answers.

Name: _____ Date of Birth: _____

Address: _____

Phone Number: _____ Year of Graduation: _____

Email Address _____

Extracurricular Activities/years participated: _____

Have you traveled outside of Pittsburgh, either within the United States and/or to another country? If yes, please list below.

Essay Questions (on a separate page (no longer than 300 words each) or submit a video answering these questions to: GuyerScholarshipSpain@gmail.com (Go to <https://www.businessinsider.com/guides/streaming/how-to-share-a-private-youtube-video> for instructions to upload and privately share your video responses with the scholarship team.)

1. What are you passionate about and how would you like to use and develop this passion?
2. Why do you want to go to Ghana, Kenya and/or Spain?
3. What is your favorite place you have traveled to?
4. If you have no limits, where would your heart take you?

Please attach a resume (if you have one.)

Reference: Please give the name, phone number and email address of an adult outside of your family that we can contact for a reference, i.e. teacher, coach, youth pastor, mentor, music director, etc.

Is there anything else you would like us to know?

Student Applicant Signature * _____

Please request a copy of your transcripts from the FC counseling department for this scholarship application. They will forward it to the scholarship committee.

Signature of Parent/Guardian _____

Phone Number and Email for Parent/Guardian _____

Please return this application via email to: GuyerScholarshipSpain@gmail.com
DEADLINE for submission of this completed application: February 14th, 2025 (midnight)

Selected candidates and their parents will be interviewed February 19-22

To learn more about any of these opportunities, please see

<https://www.afsusa.org/programs/?duration=165%2C147>

This AFS program includes:

- Round trip flight from New York to Ghana, Kenya or Spain.
- All overnight accommodations, meals, language classes, activities, and in-country transportation.
- Secondary medical insurance coverage for international travel.
- Access to a 24/7 Emergency Duty Officer
- Passport/Visa expenses and support (if needed)
- Additional help with expenses to get to and from New York as needed.

The program does not include: Vaccinations and any medication costs recommended by the CDC.

For an electronic version of this application, please scan the QR code or go to -
<https://forms.gle/Ho54LaKrJesse31P7>

